Switch detection off for six projects in 2027

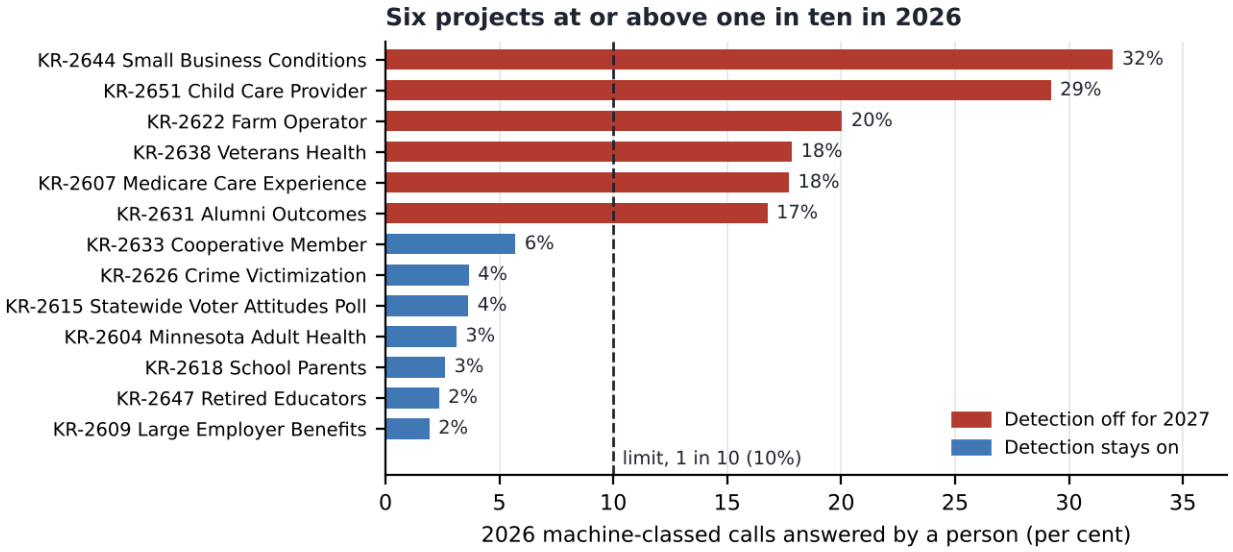
To Hailey Mullins, director of telephone operations **From** Vincent Armstrong, quality assurance lead
Date 15 January 2027 **Subject** answering machine detection at 2027 project setup (dialer policy, section 3)

Detection goes off at 2027 setup for **KR-2607 Medicare Care Experience, KR-2622 Farm Operator, KR-2631 Alumni Outcomes, KR-2638 Veterans Health, KR-2644 Small Business Conditions and KR-2651 Child Care Provider**. In 2026 between 17 and 32 per cent of the calls the dialer closed as answering machines on these projects had been answered by a person, against the policy's limit of one in ten. The other seven keep detection on; their shares ran from 2 to 6 per cent.

The call detail records only what the detector decided, so the share has to be measured. A person the detector hangs up on hears the project's recorded message, and many ring the project's line straight back, within a minute of the message; answering machine owners ring back from their messages, and anyone else the dialer rang calls the line, two and a half hours or more later. Abandoned live answers hear the same message and ring back at the same speed, which gives each project's own rate of calling back. Each project's share is its machine-classed calls rung back within 20 minutes, as a rate, divided by its abandoned answers' rate of ringing back within 20 minutes. Any window from 2 to 120 minutes, counted from the start of the call or from its end, gives the same counts.

The maker's 2.1 per cent and our 2025 listening audit (9 people in 400 machine-classed calls) were measured on short greetings on household landlines, and the pilot still reads 3 per cent in 2026. Detection mistakes people who answer with a long greeting, and the six projects call older households, farms and small businesses, where long greetings are common. A high machine-classed share is not the signal: large employers and retired educators have higher machine-classed shares than most of the six, and few of those calls were people.

Nearest the limit: KR-2633 Cooperative Member at 6 per cent stays on; KR-2631 Alumni Outcomes at 17 per cent is the lowest of the six.



Source: dialer call detail 2026 (twelve monthly exports, the repeated day of each export counted once), inbound switch log to 14 January 2027 (one call per switch call id, the quality assurance test calls left out).

Per-project counts, calling-hours exceptions, completed interviews and interviewer hours are in amd_review_2027.xlsx.